

Proto Persona Mapping: Recordings 5 to 8

Recording 5

This conversation best matches the proto persona of **Riya Sharma**, the engineering student, because the participant uses AI mainly for coding, assignments, writing improvement, and quick explanations, which connects closely with academic work and technical problem-solving. The participant does not blindly trust AI and mentions that important answers are usually verified because AI can make mistakes, showing a balanced awareness of AI's limitations. Their response also shows that they see AI as both helpful and risky: it can support learning when used properly, but overuse may reduce independent thinking. The participant clearly draws the line between help and cheating by saying AI is acceptable for understanding concepts, but becomes unethical when AI-generated answers are submitted as one's own work. Overall, this recording shows that the user is a student who depends on AI for academic support but still understands the need for verification, responsible use, and maintaining originality.

Recording 6

This conversation best matches the proto persona of **Riya Sharma**, the engineering student, because the participant mainly uses AI for academic learning, especially for difficult subjects like coding, physics, and mathematics. The participant uses AI for explanations, summaries, writing support, and quick information, which shows that AI is a regular study aid rather than just a casual tool. However, they do not fully trust AI answers and clearly mention that they double-check important information using books or reliable sources, showing awareness that AI can sometimes give incomplete or inaccurate responses. Their thoughts on AI's effect on thinking are balanced, as they believe overdependence can reduce independent thinking, but proper use can improve understanding when it supports step-by-step learning. The participant also draws a clear ethical boundary by saying AI is helpful for understanding concepts and generating ideas, but copying answers directly without effort is cheating. Overall, this recording shows a responsible student user who relies on AI for learning support while still valuing verification, effort, and genuine understanding.

Recording 7

This conversation best matches the proto persona of **Arjun Verma**, the senior software engineer, because the participant uses AI across many work-related and productivity tasks such as writing, planning, video editing, and general work, while also showing a strong habit of double-checking every AI response. The participant clearly does not fully trust AI and has experienced situations where AI gave wrong information confidently, which made them more careful and better at catching mistakes. Their responses show a mature understanding of responsibility, as they believe the user is mostly responsible if AI is used for important work and produces incorrect information. At the same time, the participant sees AI as a better way to learn when used actively, but also admits that working without AI feels harder and less efficient, especially in tech-related environments where there is pressure to keep up. Overall, this recording shows a highly aware and cautious AI user who

benefits from AI for productivity but remains skeptical, verifies outputs, and understands the risks of blind dependence.

Recording 8

This conversation best matches the proto persona of **Arjun Verma**, the senior software engineer, because the participant uses AI for almost everything, including work, writing, planning, and video editing, while still showing strong skepticism toward AI-generated answers. The participant says they double-check everything because they do not fully trust AI, and they have experienced cases where AI gave wrong answers confidently, which made them learn to identify mistakes more carefully. Their responses show that they understand AI can influence self-confidence, especially when it sounds very sure, but they still believe the user is mainly responsible when AI is used for important tasks. The participant also sees AI as a useful learning tool when used actively, but admits that working without AI feels harder to start and less efficient, especially because of pressure in tech-related environments where others are also using AI. Overall, this recording shows a cautious but highly dependent AI user who values AI for productivity and learning, while also recognizing the risks of blind trust, overreliance, and user responsibility.